

Daily Economic Briefing

Edition 19 — Monday, 14 September 2026

Coverage window: Friday 11 Sept 2026 close/after-hours through the weekend (Sat 12 – Sun 13 Sept), research cutoff approx. 20:10 ET Sun 13 Sept / 00:10 UTC 14 Sept. Prepared for Alex. Market-wide view; no portfolio tilt.

60-second read

- Equities led, but the AI-capex trade cracked at the edges.** Friday's relief rally (S&P +0.9%, Dow +1.0%, Nasdaq +1.0%) clawed back only part of a down week and was led by an AI-hardware cluster (HPE +12.44%, Dell +11.98%, HP Inc. +8.40%)^[1,2] — yet Oracle round-tripped an 8.5% opening pop into a 1.74% close below Thursday's pre-earnings level once investors priced in approx.\$28.5bn of quarterly capex and negative \$5.4bn free cash flow^[5,6], an early sign the market is starting to question AI-buildout economics even as it keeps buying the hardware suppliers.
- The Fed's live debate flipped from cut to hike.** August CPI matched the 3.4% y/y headline consensus but core ran hot at +0.3% m/m, and UMich's preliminary September sentiment collapsed to 47.8 (vs. 51.0 expected) with 1-year inflation expectations jumping to 4.6%^[19,21] — pushing Wednesday 16 Sept hike odds to 79-82% on event markets and as high as 87-98% on futures-implied readings, an unusually wide cross-venue spread^[23,24,25] heading into a meeting most of 2026 had framed as a cut debate.
- The Hormuz tanker war stayed lethal and unresolved.** An Iranian crew member was killed in a Sept 13 strike near Hengam Island, a nascent Omani-brokered diplomatic track collapsed within days over Saudi/GCC objections, and the U.S. deliberately stayed outside it^[31,48] — keeping Brent near \$104/bbl and U.S. diesel at a record \$6.06/gallon^[31], with a reported (single-sourced) reversal back above \$100 WTI Sunday night on news the talks were postponed^[15].
- Futures positioning turned more cautious into FOMC week even as the VIX fell.** VIX round-tripped from a 28-session high of 17.84 Thursday to 15.84 Friday (-11%) on CPI relief^[49,50], but leveraged funds added to net S&P 500 and Nasdaq-100 futures shorts in CFTC's week-through-8-Sept report, while Russell 2000 leveraged shorts are proportionally the most stretched of the three (-25.6% of open interest)^[52,53] — a hedged setup into both Wednesday's decision and Friday's approx.\$6.2tn options expiry^[57].
- Copper's tariff story is now a genuine cross-exchange muddle.** Comex's Dec-26 contract is wire-reported at a record approx.\$6.87/lb versus the LME's own approx.\$6.71-6.75/lb-equivalent record, both dated 8 Sept and never reconciled by any source found^[46,47], while the White House's 15% refined-copper tariff — whose possible reconsideration triggered copper's crash — remains "under evaluation" a week later with no confirm or deny^[44,45].

Assumptions, corrections and status check

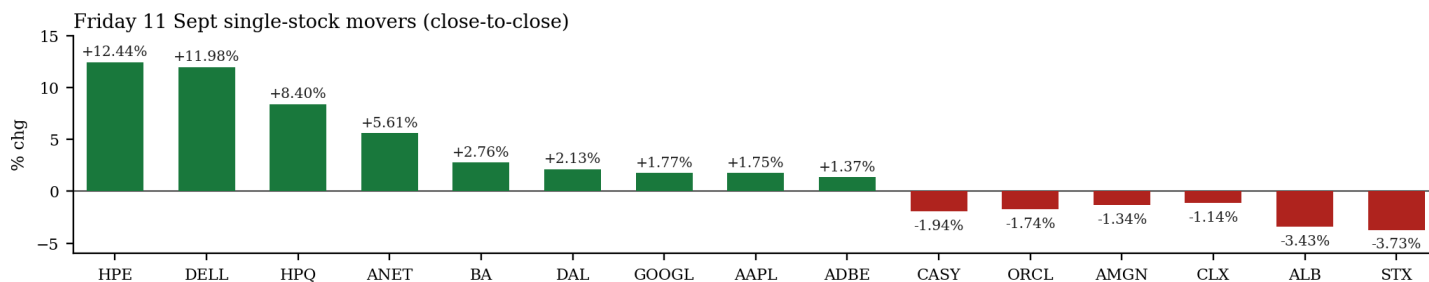
- Scheduler:** healthy — 12th consecutive clean weekday fire (single fire, no duplicate, no gap; landed approx.8 minutes after the intended 00:00 UTC slot).
- Fed Chair re-verified:** Kevin Warsh remains Chairman; Jerome Powell remains a plain Governor — confirmed fresh against the Fed's own Board of Governors biography page^[16].
- FOMC date re-verified:** the meeting runs Tue-Wed 15-16 Sept; the rate decision and press conference land Wednesday 16 Sept at 2:00pm/2:30pm ET^[17] — consistent with last edition's premise correction.
- Format change (not a data correction), effective this edition per Alex:** top/bottom page margins move to 1 inch (from 12mm/11mm) and body prose is now justified; tables, headers, tiles and the source list stay left-aligned.
- Resolved:** Oracle's Friday close is confirmed at -1.74% (\$150.28) via three independent sources against one outlier claim of +3%, which is discarded as a likely stale or intraday snapshot^[4,5,6,7].
- New disclosed conflict:** copper's 2026 record now splits by exchange — Comex approx.\$6.87/lb vs. LME approx.\$6.71-6.75/lb-equivalent, both 8 Sept, unreconciled (see item 5 above and Section 4).
- Carried and now multi-sourced:** Thursday 10 Sept's silver decline is confirmed directionally by three outlets but its magnitude still spans -2.6% to -6% depending on source/timestamp — resolved on direction, not on size.
- Delivery:** the scheduled task's own stored prompt still contains retired Step 5 GitHub/Telegram language, unchanged since edition 6 (now 13 editions, 7-19). Per the standing edition-9 judgment call, holding rather than re-attempting `update_trigger` or re-escalating on an unattended fire. This edition follows the current Delivery section: `SendUserFile` only.

1. Market recap

Index	Fri 11 Sept close	Chg	Week (vs. Fri 4 Sept)
S&P 500	7,656.98	+0.9%	-0.8%
Dow Jones Industrial Avg	52,573.29	+1.0%	-1.6%
Nasdaq Composite	26,333.04	+1.0%	-0.7%
Russell 2000	2,903.94	+0.4%	-2.4%

Stocks rebounded Friday as oil eased off Thursday's spike and August CPI printed in line, but the bounce only partly offset a down week^[1,2,10]. Sector leadership was a clean risk-on rotation: Technology (+1.32%) and Industrials (+1.07%) led on the AI-hardware capex read-through, Communication Services and Discretionary followed, while Utilities (-0.31%) and Health Care (-0.18%) were the only sectors in the red^[3]. Energy's muted +0.32% despite crude falling more than 3% on the day is a soft read-through worth flagging rather than a clean sector signal^[3,10]. Heading into Monday, two Sunday-night (13 Sept) developments hit futures and are single-sourced/lower-confidence: OpenAI's Altman ruled out an IPO this year, and Anthropic's Amodei published an essay urging AI labs to slow deployment of their most capable models — reported futures reaction put Nasdaq-100 futures -1.2%, with enterprise-software names hit hardest (Salesforce, Intuit and ServiceNow each reported -4% to -5%) while Intel and Qualcomm gained^[14].

2. Equities and earnings LEAD



Close-to-close % change, Friday 11 Sept 2026. Source: stockanalysis.com daily-close data, cross-checked against a second source for each name shown^[4].

The AI-infrastructure hardware cluster was Friday's clearest trade: **Hewlett Packard Enterprise +12.44%** to \$62.09 and **Dell Technologies +11.98%** to \$567.30 both rode the read-through from Oracle's blowout headline print and Dell's own Sept 2 disclosure of a \$95bn AI-server backlog, with HP Inc. (+8.40%) and Arista Networks (+5.61%) moving on the same sympathy wave^[2,4]. That makes **Oracle's own session** the day's most important story: shares opened as much as 8.5% above Thursday's \$152.94 close, touched \$166 intraday, then reversed through the day to finish at **\$150.28, down 1.74%** — closing lower than before the earnings were even released. Three independent sources agree on this figure; a single outlier claiming a +3% close is treated as a stale or intraday snapshot and discarded^[4,5,6,7,56]. The reversal tracks directly to the print's other half: approx.\$28.5bn of quarterly capex (more than double y/y), negative \$5.4bn free cash flow, and guidance toward approx.\$40bn of new debt-and-equity financing to fund the AI buildout, against a \$638bn RPO backlog investors are no longer taking on faith^[5,6]. **Adobe** (+1.37% to \$252.23) moved the opposite way, more than reversing an early 3% intraday drop tied to Thursday's surprise CEO-succession announcement (Anil Chakravarthy taking over in December) and guidance that only met rather than beat consensus; peers Intuit (+0.9%) and ServiceNow (+0.3%) were roughly flat, suggesting Friday's Adobe move was idiosyncratic rather than sector-wide^[8,9]. Elsewhere, Delta (+2.13%) and Boeing (+2.76%) benefited from the same oil pullback and industrials rotation, while Casey's General Stores (-1.94%) extended a guidance-driven weekly decline^[12] and Amgen (-1.34%), Seagate (-3.73%), Albemarle (-3.43%) and Clorox (-1.14%) were the session's notable idiosyncratic decliners on continuing pipeline, ex-dividend, price-target and profit-taking dynamics respectively^[4,10,11,13].

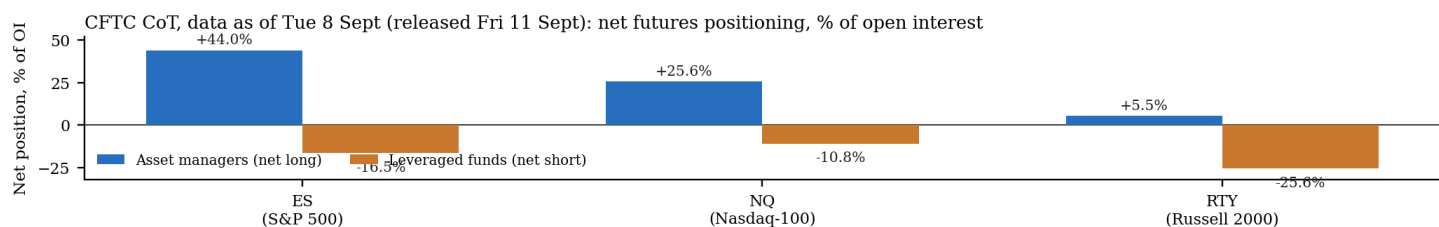
3. Macro, policy and rates

August CPI (released Friday, BLS) matched consensus at the headline level — **+0.4% m/m, +3.4% y/y** — but core ran hot at **+0.3% m/m** against a 0.2% consensus, even as the core y/y rate held at 2.4%; gasoline (+27.4% y/y) drove over a third of the monthly increase^[19,20]. The bigger surprise was the University of Michigan's preliminary September read: headline sentiment fell 3.9 points to **47.8** against a 51.0 consensus, with 1-year inflation expectations jumping to 4.6% (from an expected 4.0%) — the survey attributes the drop to "a resurgence in fuel prices and trade tensions"^[21,22]. Together, a hot core print and a sentiment/inflation-expectations shock have flipped Wednesday 16 September's FOMC debate toward a hike rather than a cut: Kalshi's own market puts hike odds at **81%**, Polymarket at approx.**79%** (up from approx.70% pre-CPI), while CME-futures-based secondary citations run as high as **87-98%** — a genuinely wide, disclosed cross-venue spread that likely reflects the known methodological gap between futures-implied and event-contract pricing rather than a resolvable disagreement^[23,24,25]. The meeting itself is confirmed via the Fed's own calendar as Tuesday-Wednesday 15-16 September, decision and press conference at 2:00/2:30pm ET Wednesday^[17]; the FOMC blackout that began 5 September continues through 17 September, and no Fed speeches were found between Governor Waller's pre-blackout 3 September remarks and this edition's cutoff^[18]. On trade, President Trump said Saturday a US-Canada deal "could come fairly soon" while repeating disputed claims about Canadian dairy tariffs; the existing 50% US tariffs on roughly \$28bn of Canadian goods and Canada's retaliatory measures remain in place with no signed agreement as of Sunday^[26]. Day-ahead: Monday 14 Sept is quiet (bill auctions only); Tuesday 15 Sept — the FOMC's first meeting day — brings Empire State Manufacturing (consensus approx.14-15 vs. 20.60 prior), Retail Sales (August; consensus estimates disagreed across sources, approx.+0.3% to +0.9% vs. -0.6% prior), the NAHB Housing Market Index (consensus 34 vs. 35 prior) and a \$18bn 20-year Treasury auction^[27,28,29].

4. Commodities and FX

Oil eased Friday as diplomatic signals briefly outweighed the ongoing Hormuz conflict: Brent traded around **\$104.3-104.4/bbl** and WTI around **\$99.22/bbl** (single-sourced, day-over-day comparison unclear given inconsistent reference points across sources — see Annex A), both still elevated versus the pre-war approx.\$66 level^[30,31]. The underlying conflict remains unresolved: a fatal strike on an Iranian commercial vessel near Hengam Island killed one crew member Sept 13 — a fourth straight day without an Iranian missile or drone launch, a tentative de-escalation signal — while a Sunday meeting in Salalah, Oman meant to open a diplomatic track on Strait transit was postponed indefinitely after Saudi Arabia and other Gulf states objected to its terms, with the US declining to attend either way^[31,48]. US diesel sits at a record national average \$6.06/gallon^[31]. Gold and silver both fell into Friday's rate-hike repricing before stabilizing: gold traded in a \$4,330-4,386/oz range and silver \$63.87-64.90/oz across sources, both roughly flat to modestly higher versus Thursday's rout, with the exact settlement figures for both metals unconfirmed at time of writing (see Annex A)^[32,33,34,35,36,37]. **Copper** is this edition's most tangled thread: Friday's price steadied around \$6.45-6.47/lb, roughly 6% off its Sept 8 peak^[38,39], but that peak itself is now a genuine cross-exchange conflict — Comex's Dec-26 contract is wire-reported (TASS) at a record approx.\$6.87/lb, while the LME's own record the same week runs approx.\$6.71-6.75/lb on a metric-tonne basis, and no source found reconciles the two^[46,47]. The White House's possible reconsideration of its 15% refined-copper tariff — the report that triggered copper's initial crash — remains neither confirmed nor denied a week later, with Commerce Secretary Lutnick still tasked with a recommendation ahead of a planned 1 January 2027 effective date^[44,45]. In FX, the dollar consolidated around DXY 99.0-99.2 ahead of Friday's CPI^[40]; EUR/USD closed 1.1597 (-0.11%) and USD/CAD traded 1.3838-1.3850, both little-changed^[41,42,43].

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning



CFTC Commitment of Traders, futures-only, data as of Tuesday 8 Sept 2026 (published Friday 11 Sept — CoT carries a standard 3-trading-day lag). Source: CFTC Traders in Financial Futures, cross-checked against an independent mirror^[52,53].

The VIX round-tripped through the window: it broke above 17 for the first time in 28 sessions Thursday (17.84-17.89, +approx.8.4-8.7%) before falling 11% to **15.84** Friday on CPI relief^[49,50,51]. This edition's CBOE feed pull was a full clean sweep for a second time (after edition 15) — every series (VIX, VIX9D 14.47, VIX3M 18.60, VIX6M 20.39, VVIX 91.28, SKEW 154.49) carried a genuinely fresh Friday timestamp, with the term structure in a fairly steep contango consistent with calm front-month conditions but still-elevated medium-term hedging demand into the FOMC and 18 September's options expiry^[49]. Underneath that calmer VIX print, futures positioning turned more cautious rather than less: in CFTC's week-through-8-September report, leveraged funds *added* to net short positions in both S&P 500 e-mini futures (net short 341,104 contracts, -16.5% of open interest) and Nasdaq-100 minis (net short 31,872 contracts, -10.8% of OI), even as asset managers held their structural net-long stance (+44.0% of OI in ES, +25.6% in NQ); Russell 2000 leveraged shorts, while roughly flat week-over-week in contract terms, are proportionally the most stretched of the three at -25.6% of open interest^[52,53]. On single names, Oracle's approx.11-11.5% options-implied move Thursday looked "cheap" only measured close-to-close (the stock finished down 1.74%); measured peak-to-trough, the session was a roughly 10-point round trip from its \$166 intraday high to Friday's \$150.28 close, a violent realized outcome the implied-move framing alone would have understated^[4,54,55]. Citadel Securities puts total US options exposure expiring between now and Friday 18 September at approx.\$9.6tn, with approx.\$6.2tn expiring that day alone — tracking to exceed June's record \$7.7tn triple-witching expiry and, per the same note, a session where supportive long-gamma dealer positioning could fade just as the FOMC decision lands two days earlier^[57]. Funding: SOFR printed 3.62% on 10 September (latest available given the New York Fed's one-day publication lag), a modest grind lower with no repo-stress signal^[58].

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Detail / consensus
Mon 14 Sept	Quiet session	3-mo/6-mo bill auctions only; no major US data ^[27]
Tue 15 Sept	FOMC meeting begins; data	Empire State Mfg (cons. approx.14-15 vs. 20.60 prior); Retail Sales Aug (cons. range approx.+0.3% to +0.9% vs. -0.6% prior); NAHB Housing (cons. 34 vs. 35); \$18bn 20-yr auction ^[27,28,29]
Wed 16 Sept	FOMC decision	Statement 2:00pm ET, Chair Warsh press conference 2:30pm ET; hike odds 79-98% across venues (see Section 3) ^[17,23,24,25]
Thu 17 Sept	FOMC blackout ends	First post-decision Fed commentary window opens ^[18]
Fri 18 Sept	Triple witching	Approx.\$6.2tn options expire; tracking to exceed June's \$7.7tn record ^[57]

Sector setup we take into the week

- AI-capex hardware (HPE, Dell, HP Inc., Arista) carries Friday's momentum, but Oracle's full round-trip reversal is the first real crack in the AI-buildout narrative this month and bears watching for read-across on the next capex-heavy print.
- Energy and travel names stay Hormuz-headline-sensitive both ways: Friday's oil pullback helped airlines and eased margin pressure, but Sunday night's reported (single-sourced) reversal back above \$100 WTI could flip that trade Monday.
- Rate-sensitive sectors (Utilities, REITs, regional banks) sit exposed to Wednesday's hike-not-cut repricing; Friday's session already showed Utilities and Health Care as the only laggards on a broadly green tape.
- Enterprise-software/"AI-disruption" names (Salesforce, Intuit, ServiceNow) head into Monday under a single-sourced but sizeable reported futures air-pocket (-4% to -5%) tied to weekend Altman/Amodei commentary — a name to confirm at Monday's open rather than treat as settled.

Annex A — Could not verify this edition

- NYSE advance/decline breadth and official GICS sector-index returns for Friday — no free source located; sector-ETF proxies used instead.
- Official (Treasury/Reuters) 10-year yield close for Friday 11 Sept — only secondary-market/live-blog references found (approx.4.93-4.99% intraday).
- Exact magnitude of three single-stock moves where sources disagreed: Seagate (-3.73% vs. -3.1%), Albemarle (-3.43% vs. -2.5%), Clorox (-1.14% vs. -3.1%) — stockanalysis.com's close-price figures used as the more authoritative source in each case.
- Sunday-night futures percentages (Dow, S&P, Nasdaq-100 and the Salesforce/Intuit/ServiceNow/Intel/Qualcomm moves) — rest on a single secondary aggregator; the original CNBC live-blog could not be fetched directly.
- The Sunday Hormuz talks-postponement report and the reported Sunday-night oil reversal above \$100 WTI — both rest on a single non-wire source, not corroborated by AP/Reuters/Bloomberg in this pass.
- Live CME FedWatch hike probability — the tool itself blocks fetching; the 87-98% range used in this edition comes from secondary citations only, and should be read as less rigorously sourced than the Kalshi/Polymarket figures.
- Exact August Retail Sales consensus figure — a single aggregator's own calendar tool showed internally inconsistent forecast fields (+0.3% vs. +0.9%); not reconciled against a second source.
- Precise details of the Sept 13 Hengam Island strike (vessel, attacker attribution beyond "unidentified") — primary wire coverage was blocked by robots.txt; only headline-level confirmation obtained.
- Friday's WTI close as a clean day-over-day change from Thursday — single-sourced (Forbes Advisor) with an ambiguous reference point; treat the level, not the implied change, as the usable figure.
- Precise Friday closing levels for DXY and USD/JPY — sources gave pre-close/consolidation ranges rather than a clean settlement print.
- A second, extractable source confirming TASS's exact Comex Dec-26 copper print (approx.\$6.873-6.844/lb, 8 Sept) — a same-day Bloomberg headline corroborates that a record was reported but its page was blocked, so the number itself remains single-sourced.
- Any reconciliation between the Comex (approx.\$6.87/lb) and LME (approx.\$6.71-6.75/lb-equivalent) copper ATH figures — not found in any source.
- CBOE daily put/call ratio, the MOVE index and third-party dealer gamma-exposure (GEX) levels for this window — standing known-hard-to-source items, none located with a dated Friday figure.
- Official CME/ICE settlement prices (VIX futures, index options) — standing known limitation, not sourced.
- HP Inc.'s specific Friday catalyst beyond a secondary reference to an "RBC initiation" — the underlying note was not independently located.

Annex B — Sources

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">[1] AP, "How major US stock indexes fared Friday" — lancasteronline.com mirror[2] Motley Fool, "Stock market today Sept 11: HPE surges on AI infrastructure demand"[3] stockanalysis.com, SPDR sector ETF history pages (XLK/XLI/XLC/XLY/XLRE/XLF/XLB/XLP/XLE/XLU/XLV)[4] stockanalysis.com, single-stock daily-close history pages (HPE, DELL, HPQ, ANET, BA, DAL, GOOGL, AAPL, ADBE, ORCL, STX, ALB, CLX, AMGN, FDS, CASY, PTC)[5] AllWeatherFinance, "Oracle shares jumped 8.5% before falling back"[6] 247wallst.com, "Oracle jumped 36% in a day after last September's earnings, but traders are betting against it tonight"[7] Blockonomi, "Oracle (ORCL) stock soars on AI demand" (outlier +3% claim, discarded)[8] 247wallst.com, "Adobe pulls back then recovers as CEO handoff meets soft Q4 outlook"[9] Yahoo Finance, "Adobe stock drops on surprise CEO transition"[10] TheStreet, "Stock market today: Dow, S&P 500, Nasdaq updates Sept 11 2026"[11] Motley Fool, "Why did Casey's General Stores stock tank this week?"[12] Fool.com / STL.news, S&P 500 weekly winners and losers, week of Sept 11 2026[13] Yahoo Finance, "Amgen shares fall as investors assess" Lp(a) pipeline read-through[14] Time.news, "Stock futures slide amid AI safety concerns and rising oil prices"[15] TradingStrategyGuides, "Stock market recap Sept 13 2026: Hormuz talks postponed"[16] federalreserve.gov, Board of Governors biographies page | <ul style="list-style-type: none">[17] federalreserve.gov, FOMC meeting calendar; Federal Reserve X/Twitter post on press-conference timing[18] federalreserve.gov, 2026 speeches page[19] BLS, Consumer Price Index news release, August 2026[20] Nowflation, August 2026 CPI forecaster/consensus tracker[21] American Bankers Association Banking Journal, "Preliminary consumer sentiment decreased 3.9 points in September"[22] InvestingLive, "UMich September consumer sentiment 47.8 vs. 51.0 expected"[23] Kalshi News, "Fed rate hike odds: core CPI, September 2026"[24] Polymarket, "Fed rate cut by [date]" event page[25] usethebitcoin.com, secondary CME FedWatch citation[26] BNN Bloomberg, "Trump says trade deal with Canada could come fairly soon"[27] Investrade, weekly event calendar (data-release consensus figures)[28] Trading Economics, United States economic calendar[29] Kiplinger, "This week's economic calendar"[30] Forbes Advisor, "Oil prices today"[31] GlobalSecurity.org, Iran War 2026 day-by-day operations tracker[32] Forbes Advisor, "Gold price today"[33] Yahoo Finance, "Gold price today, Friday September 11 2026"[34] USAGOLD, Daily precious metals market report, Sept 11 2026[35] Forbes Advisor, "Silver price today"[36] Trading Economics, silver commodity page[37] Fortune, "Current price of silver," Sept 11 2026[38] Rio Times, "Copper markets LatAm," Sat 12 Sept 2026 wrap[39] Trading Economics, copper commodity page | <ul style="list-style-type: none">[40] FXStreet, "US Dollar Index price forecast: DXY consolidates around 99.00 ahead of US CPI"[41] Trading Economics, Euro area currency page[42] Vantage Markets, "USD/CAD, oil four-month high, US CPI Sept 11 2026"[43] TIO Markets, "USD/CAD market analysis, technical forecast," Sept 11 2026[44] Mining.com / Reuters, "White House copper tariff plan stalls amid affordability concerns"[45] Business Recorder, "Copper set to snap 10-week winning streak on White House tariff hesitation"[46] TASS, "Copper hits record on Comex," Sept 8 2026[47] Bloomingbit, LME copper record coverage[48] KTVZ (CNN wire mirror), "Iran meeting with Gulf countries to discuss Strait of Hormuz deal without the US"[49] CBOE, delayed-quotes API (VIX, VIX9D, VIX3M, VIX6M, VVIX, SKEW)[50] Vantage Markets, "VIX jumps to 28-session high on oil, inflation data"[51] TheStreet, live-blog market updates, Sept 11 2026[52] CFTC, Traders in Financial Futures — Futures Only, data as of 8 Sept 2026[53] Tradingster, CFTC CoT mirror (ES/NQ/RTY contracts)[54] SpotGamma, "Oracle earnings preview: AI backlog, options-implied move"[55] Trader Central, "ORCL Q1 FY2027 earnings options" preview[56] Investing.com, ORCL historical data page[57] Citadel Securities, "September Setup" global market intelligence note[58] sofrrate.com, SOFR historical data aggregator |
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Method: every figure above is sourced and cited inline; where sources disagreed, the more authoritative one was used and the disagreement disclosed rather than silently resolved. Nothing in this briefing was estimated, inferred, or filled from memory — items that could not be verified within the research window are listed in Annex A rather than approximated. Four parallel research passes (macro/policy, equities/earnings, commodities/FX, derivatives/positioning) were run for this edition, each independently instructed to verify session dates and cross-check disputed figures against a second source before filing.